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A09 Ethical and Societal Implications of AI – Case Study

Introduction

Artificial Intelligence is becoming a big part of everyday life, from social media algorithms to self-driving cars. While AI has many benefits, it also raises important ethical and societal concerns. This case study will focus on the use of AI in hiring processes, examining both the advantages and the potential risks involved.

Case Study: AI in Hiring

Many companies now use AI-powered tools to help screen job applicants. These systems can review resumes, analyze keywords, and even evaluate video interviews. The goal is to make hiring faster and more efficient while reducing human bias. One example is when companies use AI to scan resumes and rank candidates based on qualifications. This helps recruiters save time by focusing only on the most qualified applicants. AI can also analyze patterns in successful employees and look for similar traits in new candidates.

Ethical Concerns

Even though AI in hiring can be helpful, it also raises serious ethical issues. One major concern is bias. If the AI system is trained on data that reflects past hiring decisions, it may continue those same biases. For example, if a company historically hired more men than women, the AI might favor male candidates without realizing it. Another issue is transparency. Many AI systems are considered “black boxes,” meaning it is unclear how they make decisions. This can make it difficult for applicants to understand why they were rejected, which may feel unfair. Privacy is also a concern. Some AI tools analyze facial expressions or voice tones during video interviews. This raises questions about how much personal data is being collected and whether it is being used responsibly.

Societal Implications

The use of AI in hiring can impact society in several ways. On one hand, it can create more opportunities by helping companies find talent more efficiently. On the other hand, it may increase inequality if certain groups are unfairly filtered out by biased systems. There is also the risk of over-reliance on technology. If companies depend too much on AI, they may overlook

important human qualities that are difficult for machines to measure, such as creativity or emotional intelligence.

Possible Solutions

To address these issues, companies should regularly audit their AI systems to check for bias and ensure fairness. They should also be transparent about how their AI tools work and give applicants clear feedback when possible. Additionally, human oversight is important. AI should assist in decision-making, not replace it entirely. Having humans involved in the final hiring decision can help reduce the risk of unfair outcomes.

Conclusion

AI has the potential to improve the hiring process, but it also comes with ethical and societal challenges. Issues like bias, transparency, and privacy must be carefully managed. By using AI responsibly and maintaining human involvement, companies can take advantage of its benefits while minimizing its risks.